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Defense: Walshe lied, but didn't kill wife

Disposed of her body because he panicked after she died naturally, attorney says at trial

By Sean Cotter
and Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

DEDHAM — As the murder trial of Brian R. Walshe began on Monday, his lawyers, for the first time, laid out his defense: Though he indeed moved his wife's corpse and lied to police about it, he'd only done so in an irrational panic after she suddenly died of natural causes in the bed they shared.

"Brian Walshe never killed Ana," defense attorney Larry Tipton told the jury during his opening statement on Monday in Norfolk Superior Court. "Brian Walshe

never thought about killing Ana."

Tipton said Walshe never told anyone, because, "He didn't think anyone would believe that Ana Walshe was alive one minute and dead the next."

Walshe, 50, of Cohasset, is charged with murdering 39-year-old Ana Walshe in the early morning of New Year's Day 2023 as their relationship worsened and his monetary problems deepened following his conviction for art forgery. The case has received national media attention due to the bizarre and grisly details alleged; prosecutors say he searched the in-

WALSHE, Page A6



GREG DERR/POOL

Brian Walshe in Norfolk Superior Court in Dedham on Monday, where his trial in the murder of his wife began.

Trump's deficit vow sees little progress

Budget office says shortfall reduced by 2% this year

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — President Trump took office in January promising to slash the federal budget deficit, but he's made little progress so far — and the prospects aren't looking good going forward.

The federal government ended its recent fiscal year this fall with a \$1.8 trillion deficit, essentially the same as the previous year. That's despite the DOGE initiative intended to take a chainsaw to government spending, widespread layoffs of federal workers, and a slew of new tariffs that generated nearly \$200 billion in additional revenue.

The Congressional Budget Office's year-end calculations showed that Trump's deficit-reduction efforts trimmed the deficit by just \$41 billion, or 2 percent, compared to 2024. Budget cuts were offset by spending increases, including an 8.3 percent jump in the interest paid on the national debt, which has continued to balloon this year to \$38 trillion. Those annual interest payments on the accumulated federal debt topped \$1 trillion for the first time.

"The fact that [the deficit is] basically the same

DEFICIT, Page A5

PATRIOTS OVERPOWER GIANTS



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

New England Patriots wide receiver Kayshon Boutte celebrated his touchdown against the New York Giants during the first quarter of Monday night's game at Gillette Stadium. The Patriots dominated the game, winning 33-15. **C1.**

Mass. hospitals face strain from Medicaid cuts

Officials fear influx of patients who can't pay

By Marin Wolf
GLOBE STAFF

Dr. Brien Barnewolt can walk into the Tufts Medical Center emergency department on any day and find more than 40 patients waiting for a bed.

An overworked and overcrowded emergency room is nothing new, nor is it unique to Tufts. But the influx of patients who can't find or can't pay for primary care is about to balloon, experts say, as parts of President Trump's Big Beautiful Bill take effect. That could mean even more people seeking emergency care, placing further strain on already-stretched hospitals.

"We're busy, we're crowded, and it's stressful," said Barnewolt, chairman and chief of emergency medicine at Tufts Medical Center.

HOSPITALS, Page A6

A day of hope, empathy, and giving

Nonprofits say need across state surges as cuts deepen

By Claire Thornton
GLOBE STAFF

After fleeing from domestic violence last winter, Jadzeiyah Brown bounced between living in a Dedham storage unit and sleeping in tents outdoors.

Brown said she never let her guard down or got a good night's sleep because she spent her hours watching out for her

daughter, who was 3 years old at the time.

In time, Brown — who was pregnant with her second child — got a spot at a Dorchester family shelter run by Catholic Charities Boston and then a new apartment. Catholic Charities volunteers even threw her a shower for her baby boy, who was born this summer.

"It was like watching the sunrise," Brown, 25, said about moving into her apartment on Nov. 1.

Giving Tuesday — a national day of philanthropy held on the first Tuesday after Thanksgiving — has leaders of Boston-area nonprofits hopeful for the donations they need this year

GIVING TUESDAY, Page A7

In the news

Ukraine's leader is shoring up support in Europe for security guarantees

amid diplomatic wrangling over the US-led effort to end the war with Russia. **A3.**

Three out of five Massachusetts registered voters said they would back a rent control measure, a new Suffolk University/Boston Globe poll says. **B1.**

Harvard University last week tapped three deep-pocketed alumni with experience in asset management to help shepherd its endowment, the \$56.9 billion fund that powers the wealthiest university in the world. **D1.**

Children who had a smartphone by age 12 were at higher risk of depression, obesity, and insufficient sleep than those who did not yet have one, according to a study published in the journal Pediatrics. **A2.**



Slush up

Tuesday: Rain, snow mix.

Wednesday: Mostly sunny.

Obituaries, **C9.**

Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**

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